

Financial Mathematics

(MATH35400/MATHM5400)

Problem Class 5 – 20 February 2026 ¹

Problems:

1. (2020 exam, level 3, Q2c) Consider a model with two periods and one risky security where the interest rate is $r = 0$ and the price process is given by the following table:

State	$t = 0$	$t = 1$	$t = 2$
ω_1	10	16	18
ω_2	10	16	12
ω_3	10	8	12
ω_4	10	8	6

We consider two options:

- An *Asian* option with strike price 14 expiring at time 2, so that its payoff is given by

$$X = \left(\frac{S_0 + S_1 + \cdots + S_T}{3} - 14 \right)^+.$$

- A *look-back* option with strike price 14 expiring at time 2, so that its payoff is given by

$$Y = \left(\max_{i=0, \dots, T} S_i - 14 \right)^+.$$

- (a) Calculate the risk-neutral probability measure $\mathbb{Q}$ and specify $\mathbb{Q}(\{\omega_i\})$ for $i = 1, \dots, 4$.
 - (b) Determine $X(\omega_i)$ and $Y(\omega_i)$ for $i = 1, \dots, 4$.
 - (c) Determine the risk-neutral prices of X and Y at time $t = 0$.
 - (d) Find replicating portfolios for each of the claims X and Y .
2. (2018 exam, Q2 (b ii)) Consider a two period model with zero interest rate and a single risky asset whose price is given in the table below.

ω_k	$t = 0$	$t = 1$	$t = 2$
ω_1	$S_0 = 6$	$S_1 = 9$	$S_2 = 10$
ω_2	$S_0 = 6$	$S_1 = 9$	$S_2 = 7$
ω_3	$S_0 = 6$	$S_1 = 3$	$S_2 = 7$
ω_4	$S_0 = 6$	$S_1 = 3$	$S_2 = 1$

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This model is complete and $\mathbb{Q}(\{\omega_1\}) = 1/3$, $\mathbb{Q}(\{\omega_2\}) = 1/6$, $\mathbb{Q}(\{\omega_3\}) = 1/6$, $\mathbb{Q}(\{\omega_4\}) = 1/3$ is a risk-neutral measure.

A *double* European option gives the holder the right to *buy or sell* the risky asset at time $t = 2$ for price K . Write down the pay-off function for this option in terms of K , then calculate its time zero price by risk-neutral valuation in the case $K = 7$.